

agnostic. It's also rather easy for the developers to continue adding their plugins and devices to the system. One other great feature of the tool is that the user can create their own User Interface. How cool is that?

To make OpenHAB work, you need to run it on a computer that can run a JVM (Java Virtual Machine). One of the most affordable options for that is Raspberry Pi but of course, that's not by any means the only option. You are also going to need a device which enables the hub- in this case, the computer in which the OpenHAB software is installed to communicate with your smart devices. The controller will help you connect to the mesh network. OpenHAB also requires bindings-which essentially bind together the different automation rules from OpenHAB with other devices. MQTT is a good choice on this.

Once you have these things in place, you will have to create a list of items in OpenHAB. The items in question aren't just the physical devices in the network, they could also be parameters like the time of the day or temperature. After configuring the items, you can set up the sitemap. Then the items would appear on your user interface. It's possible to program your sitemap so that the things you want to be shown will appear-like battery level and temperature etc.

After this comes the part in which you create the rules. The rules are to be written in XTend- a language like Java. So, if you aren't conversant with programming you will have a tough time doing this. Basically, to set up rules, you need to do two things: one is to give every rule a name of your choice and the other is to set up triggers like a change in temperature for the motion sensor to be triggered or any other event to take place.

Once you have set up the rule, you are all set to control your smart devices using the OpenHAB app. The app is free and available for both Android and iOS devices. A key advantage of OpenHAB is that whenever a new technology is out, you can easily add it to OpenHAB rather than procuring a new system. This saves quite a bit of money, of course.

Domoticz

The reason why Domoticz is so useful a software for home automation is that it supports a rather wide array of devices, this could be anything from weather stations to smoke detectors and remote controls. A high number of additional third party integrations are listed on the Domoticz website. Domoticz is designed with an HTML5 front end. This means that it can be accessed from both desktop browsers and smartphones.